AI Assisted Coding

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Assignment Number: 12.1 / 24

Lab 12: Algorithms with AI Assistance – Sorting, Searching, and Optimizing Algorithms

Lab Objectives

- **Use AI to assist in designing and implementing fundamental data structures in Python**
- **Learn prompt-based structure creation, optimization, and documentation**
- **Improve understanding of Lists, Stacks, Queues, Linked Lists, Graphs, and Hash Tables**
- **Enhance readability and performance with AI-generated suggestions**

Task 1: Merge Sort Implementation

Code Explanation

Merge Sort is a divide and conquer algorithm that divides the list into smaller parts until each sublist contains only one element. Then it merges the sublists by comparing elements and arranging them in sorted order. This process continues until the complete list is sorted. The algorithm has a consistent time complexity of O(n log n) in all cases, which makes it efficient for large datasets. However, it requires extra memory during the merging process, so its space complexity is O(n). It is also a stable sorting algorithm.

AI Prompt Used

Write a Python function named merge_sort(arr) to implement the Merge Sort algorithm. Include proper docstrings explaining time and space complexity and provide test cases.

Task 2: Binary Search

Code Explanation

Binary Search works only on sorted data and reduces the search space by half in every step. It compares the target element with the middle element of the list and continues the search in the left or right half based on comparison. This makes the algorithm much faster than linear search for large datasets. The best case occurs when the element is found in the middle, which takes O(1) time, while the average and worst cases take O(log n). Since this implementation uses an iterative approach, the space complexity is O(1).

AI Prompt Used

Generate a Python function binary_search(arr, target) that returns the index of the target element or -1 if not found. Include docstrings explaining best, average, and worstcase complexity.

Task 3: Inventory Management System

Recommended Algorithms

Operation	Algorithm	Justification
Search by Product ID	Hashing	Fast lookup
Search by Name	Hash Table	Efficient retrieval
Sort by Price	Merge Sort	Stable and efficient Suitable for large
Sort by Quantity	Merge Sort	data

Code Explanation

Large inventory systems require fast searching and sorting. Hashing is used to search products quickly using product IDs because it provides constant time complexity on average. Python dictionaries work efficiently for this purpose. Sorting products based on price or quantity helps in analysis and decision-making, and Merge Sort or Python's built-in sorting ensures stability and efficiency. This approach improves performance even when the dataset grows large.

AI Prompt Used

Suggest efficient searching and sorting algorithms for an inventory system with thousands of products. Implement Python functions and justify the selection.

Task 4: Smart Hospital Patient Management System

Recommended Algorithms

Operation	Algorithm	Justification
Search by Patient ID	Hashing	Instant access
Search by Name	Hash Table	Efficient

Sort by Severity **Priority sorting Critical cases first**

Sort by Bill **Merge Sort** **Efficient**

```python
class HashTable:
    """Hash table using chaining."""

    def __init__(self, size=10):
        self.size = size
        self.table = [[] for _ in range(size)]

    def _hash(self, key):
        return hash(key) % self.size

    def insert(self, key, value):
        """Insert key-value."""
        index = self._hash(key)
        for pair in self.table[index]:
            if pair[0] == key:
                pair[1] = value
                return
        self.table[index].append([key, value])

    def search(self, key):
        """Search value."""
        index = self._hash(key)
        for pair in self.table[index]:
            if pair[0] == key:
                return pair[1]
        return None

    def delete(self, key):
        """Delete key."""
        index = self._hash(key)
        for i, pair in enumerate(self.table[index]):
            if pair[0] == key:
                self.table[index].pop(i)
                return
```

Task 5: University Examination Result Processing

Code Explanation

Large universities process thousands of results, so fast searching is essential. Hashing provides efficient retrieval of student records. Sorting based on marks helps generate rank lists quickly and accurately. Efficient algorithms reduce processing time and improve academic management.

AI Prompt Used

Identify efficient searching and sorting methods for university results and implement Python functions with justification.

Task 6: Online Food Delivery Platform

Recommended Algorithms

Operation Algorithm Justification Search by Order ID

Hashing Real-time system

Sort by Delivery Time Merge or Heap Sort Priority handling

Sort by Price Quick or Merge Sort Efficient for large data

Code Explanation

Food delivery platforms handle real-time data, so quick search and sorting are critical. Hashing enables instant order lookup. Sorting by delivery time improves efficiency and customer satisfaction, while sorting by price supports business analysis. Efficient algorithms ensure scalability and faster performance.

AI Prompt Used

Suggest optimized algorithms for searching and sorting in an online food delivery platform and implement them in Python with justification.

Conclusion

This lab demonstrates how AI can assist in selecting and implementing efficient searching and sorting algorithms. Merge Sort and Binary Search provide strong performance for large datasets, while hashing ensures fast real-time lookup. These techniques improve scalability, performance, and reliability in real-world applications.